

Week 1.1 — Kickoff — Forming the Company

Sunday, June 14, 2026 · 3:00 PM

Eleven of us crammed into Mr. Holcombe's living room tonight for the first meeting of the season — twelve on the roster, one absent. We watched the slide deck on the TV with the family dog stretched out on the rug like he was officially on the roster too. We learned what the MATE ROV Competition actually is, what it means to be a RANGER-class company (not a "club"), and that the season ends at our regional next April — likely Dauphin Island Sea Lab, depending on which district we land in when registration closes. Not all of us will be the six standing on the pool deck that day — but most of the room came in wanting to do this, which is a good way to start. We didn't elect officers tonight. We're each taking a week to think about which role fits us and coming back with a first and second choice.

2	11/12	\$0	1
HOURS	STUDENTS	SPENT	DOG ON THE RUG

TODAY'S ROLES

NOTETAKER Mentor-led	SAFETY BRIEFER Mentor-led	PHOTOGRAPHER Mentor-led	TIMEKEEPER Mentor-led
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Rotation starts at Meeting 1.2.

DECISIONS MADE

- Meeting cadence: 3 PM on Sundays, with extra weekday meetings when the season calls for them.
- Officer elections deferred to Meeting 1.2.
- Mechanical Lead will be broken into sub-areas (frame, manipulator, payload).
- Considering Deputies for some officer roles — second-in-command and backup. Final structure to be decided once the officers are elected.
- Software Lead starts studying prior teams' open-source code right away.
- Spiral development is our build philosophy. We build, test, fix, repeat.
- Team Drive set up with a project notebook and a photo log.
- Parent photo-consent forms required before any team photo goes on the public site.

ACTION ITEMS

ITEM	OWNER	DUE
Distribute parent photo-consent forms	Advisor	by 1.2
Bring first + second choice for officer role	Every student	1.2
Watch MATE pre-watch: "Using Tools and Soldering & Waterproofing"	Every student	by 1.2
Bring closed-toe shoes (soldering irons on the table)	Every student	1.2
Update team document links on the website	Advisor	by 1.2
Define Mechanical Lead sub-roles	CEO + Mech Lead	by 1.3
Define Deputy structure across all officer roles	CEO	by 1.3

WHAT WE LEARNED

- A RANGER company is bigger than "a school club." It has a budget, a schedule, deputies, and people who own real jobs.
- Spiral development beats waterfall — build, test, fix, repeat, not draft a perfect plan and then build once.
- Safety briefs aren't theater. Real engineering and dive teams do them every job; we do them every meeting.

LOOKING AHEAD

Next Sunday at 3 PM is Class 1.2 — Soldering Bootcamp. Closed-toe shoes required. Officer elections happen at the top of the meeting, so we each show up with a first and second choice ready.

MADE POSSIBLE BY

